

EXECUTABLE SIDE PROJECT — PLAYBOOK

CompetIA

An automated competitive-intelligence digest you can build and run yourself

Owner: Felipe de Almeida · Certified Intelligence Professional (CIP)

Goal: Ship a working v1 in a weekend, get 3 design partners in 30 days, run it as a real side project.

The idea, in one line

Pick any company; every Monday, CompetIA emails its team a sharp brief of what competitors did last week — pricing moves, launches, hiring signals, reviews — each item summarized with a “so what?” by AI.

Why you: this sits exactly on your competitive-intelligence certification and strategy background. You already know what a good brief looks like — the project is productizing your own expertise.

1. The problem

Strategy teams, founders and PMs all want to track competitors, but it is done manually and inconsistently: scattered tabs, ad-hoc Google Alerts, and briefs that only get written when someone has time. The signal exists; the discipline and synthesis don't.

2. Who it's for (and your first design partners)

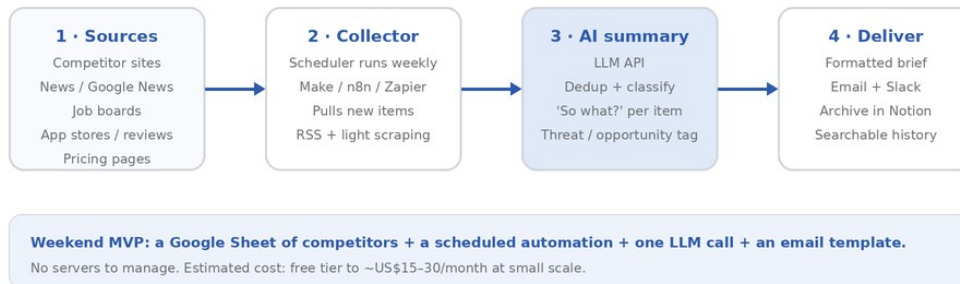
- **Primary:** Heads of Strategy / Product / Marketing at small-to-mid companies without a dedicated CI analyst.
- **Beachhead:** start in a niche you understand — e.g., Brazilian fintech or marketplaces — so your briefs are credibly good.
- **First 3 partners:** people in your network who own a competitive set; offer the weekly brief free in exchange for feedback.

3. The product

A weekly email + archive. Each edition: 5–10 items, grouped by competitor, each with a one-line summary and a tagged implication (Threat / Opportunity / Watch). One-click ‘ask a follow-up’. That's the whole v1.

4. How it works

CompetIA — pipeline (low-code)



Four stages: collect public signals, summarize with an LLM, format, deliver. No servers — it runs on a scheduler and an LLM API.

5. Build v1 this weekend

Path A — No-code (fastest, recommended for v1)

- Step 1** — List 5 competitors in a Google Sheet, each with their site, blog/news, careers page, and review/app-store URLs.
- Step 2** — In Make (or n8n / Zapier), create a weekly scenario that pulls new items via Google News RSS + each site's RSS, plus a simple HTTP fetch for pages without feeds.
- Step 3** — Send the collected items to an LLM API with a fixed prompt: dedup, summarize each in one line, tag Threat/Opportunity/Watch, and write a 3-line 'top of mind'.
- Step 4** — Format the output into an email template and send via the automation; append the edition to a Notion database for the archive.
- Step 5** — Schedule it for Monday 7am. Done — that's a working product.

Path B — Light-code (more control, later)

Swap Make for a small Python script (feedparser + requests + an LLM SDK) on a free scheduler (GitHub Actions cron / Render). Same four stages, fully yours, easier to customize prompts and sources.

6. Cost & time

Item	No-code (Path A)	Light-code (Path B)
Build time to v1	~1 weekend	~2 weekends
Monthly cost	Free tier → ~US\$15–30	~US\$5–15 (LLM only)
Skills needed	None (drag-and-drop)	Basic Python
Best for	Validating demand now	Scaling / customizing

7. Launch: first users in 30 days

6. **Week 1** — Build v1 (above) for ONE niche you know.
7. **Week 2** — Run it for yourself; tune prompts until the brief is genuinely good. This is your CI judgment at work.
8. **Week 3** — Onboard 3 design partners from your network; send their personalized brief weekly; collect feedback.
9. **Week 4** — Add a simple landing page + 'subscribe' form; share the best edition publicly on LinkedIn (doubles as personal-brand content).

8. 30 / 60 / 90 milestones

Horizon	Milestone	Signal of success
30 days	v1 live + 3 design partners	Partners open every edition; give feedback
60 days	10–20 subscribers in one niche	Organic shares; replies asking follow-ups
90 days	First paid pilot or sponsor	Someone pays for a custom brief

9. Pricing & path to a real product

- **Free:** public weekly brief for one niche — builds audience and your brand.
- **Paid:** custom competitor set + private delivery (Slack/email) at a monthly fee per company.
- **Upsell:** deeper on-demand teardowns — exactly your CI specialty.

Even if it never scales, it is a live portfolio asset: a product you conceived, built, and operated — and recurring LinkedIn content in your target domain.

10. Risks & how to handle them

- **Source reliability:** feeds break and sites change. Keep sources in the Sheet so fixing one is a 1-line edit; start with RSS-friendly sources.
- **Quality bar:** a mediocre brief is worse than none. Keep the human-in-the-loop review for v1; your CI judgment is the moat.
- **Compliance:** only use public information; respect site terms and rate limits; never scrape gated/private data.
- **Time:** automate ruthlessly; the weekly human step should be < 30 minutes.

Appendix — toolbox

Need	No-code option	Light-code option
Source list	Google Sheets	YAML / Sheet
Collection + schedule	Make / n8n / Zapier	Python + GitHub Actions cron
Summarization	LLM API node	LLM SDK
Delivery	Email/Slack module	SMTP / Slack webhook

Need	No-code option	Light-code option
Archive	Notion database	Notion API / SQLite
Landing + signup	Carrd / Notion site	Simple static site